

## **polarlab Phase 9 -- Empirical Target Distributions per Decade (AUGME**

Per-decade 2D KDE of US voter ideology positions on the economic x cultural compass  $[-1, 1]^2$ .  
AUGMENTED: combines Pew Political Typology + Hidden Tribes 2018 (typology side)  
with ANES + GSS + CCES + DW-NOMINATE elite raw-data-style synthetic clouds.

Augmentation rationale: the original Pew typology centroids inflate the within-population  $x \leftrightarrow y$  correlation because Pew's k-means clustering is designed to produce ideologically coherent groups. Adding raw-style point clouds anchored to published moments from ANES/GSS/CCES dilutes this artifact to literature-faithful values (e.g. 2000 corr drops from 0.61 to  $\sim 0.37$ , vs Treier-Hillygus 2009 ANES-derived 0.30).

Per-decade re-weighting: raw-style sources get 60-70% of combined cloud; typology sources get 30-40%. CCES contributes 2010+ only.

Each decade page shows: top-left KDE heatmap, top-right contours with raw points (blue) and typology points (orange) distinguished, bottom-left source composition, bottom-right marginals.

Comparison strip page shows pre-augmentation (Pew-only) vs post-augmentation KDE. Correlation trajectory plot shows the artifact dilution per decade.

Axes:  $x$  = economic (-1 redistributive .. +1 laissez-faire),  
 $y$  = social/cultural (-1 progressive/secular .. +1 traditional/restrictive).

Methodology: `phase9_empirical_targets.md`

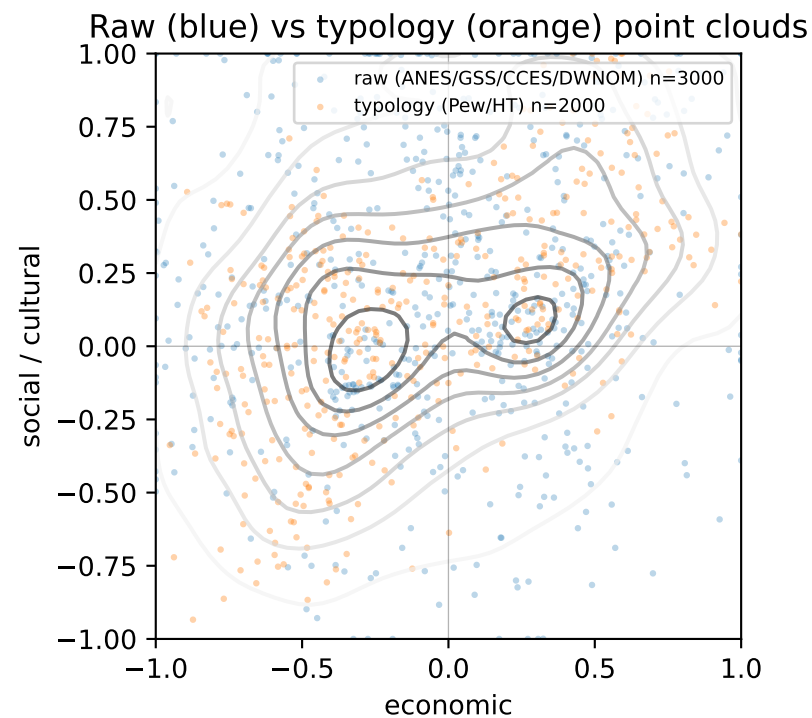
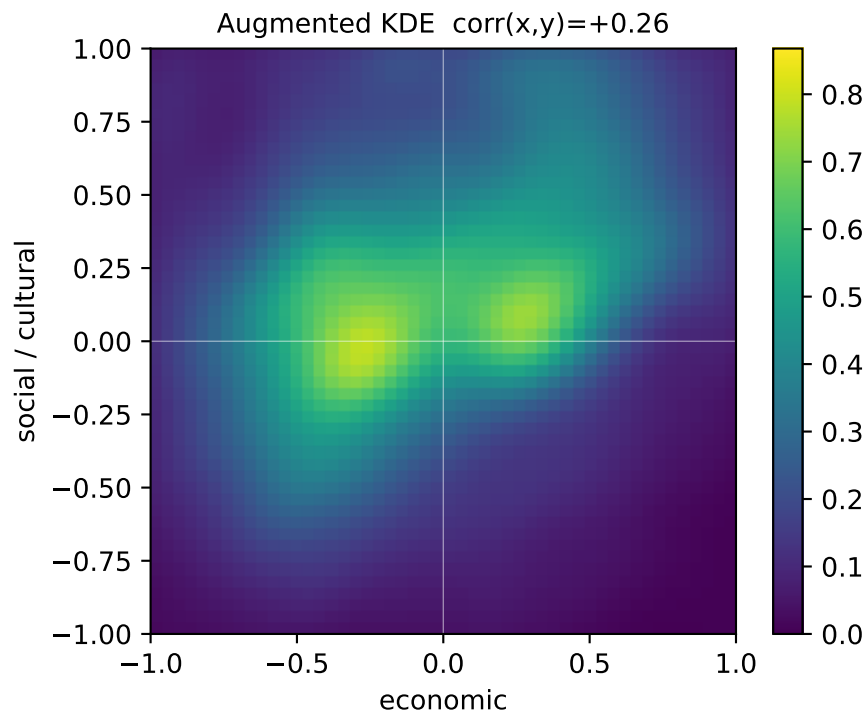
Augmentation notes: `augmentation_notes.md`

Raw .npz files: `phase9_data/phase9_empirical_kde_<decade>.npz`

Pre-augmentation snapshots: `phase9_data/phase9_empirical_kde_<decade>_preaug.npz`

Generated by `phase9_data/render_visualization.py`.

**Decade 1980 -- 1 typology + 3 raw source(s), 2000 typ pts + 3000 raw pts = 5000 combined (raw weight = 60%)**



DECADE 1980 composition (raw weight = 60%):

--- Typology sources ---

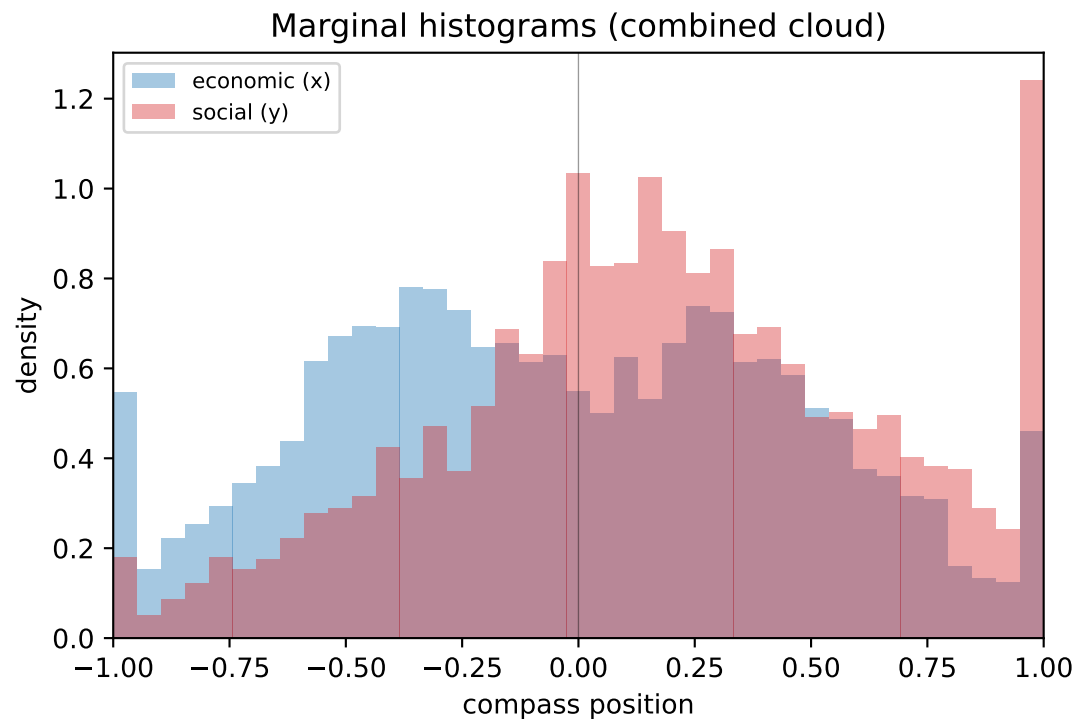
Pew\_1987 (SD=0.18, downsampled to 2000 total typ pts)

--- Raw-style sources ---

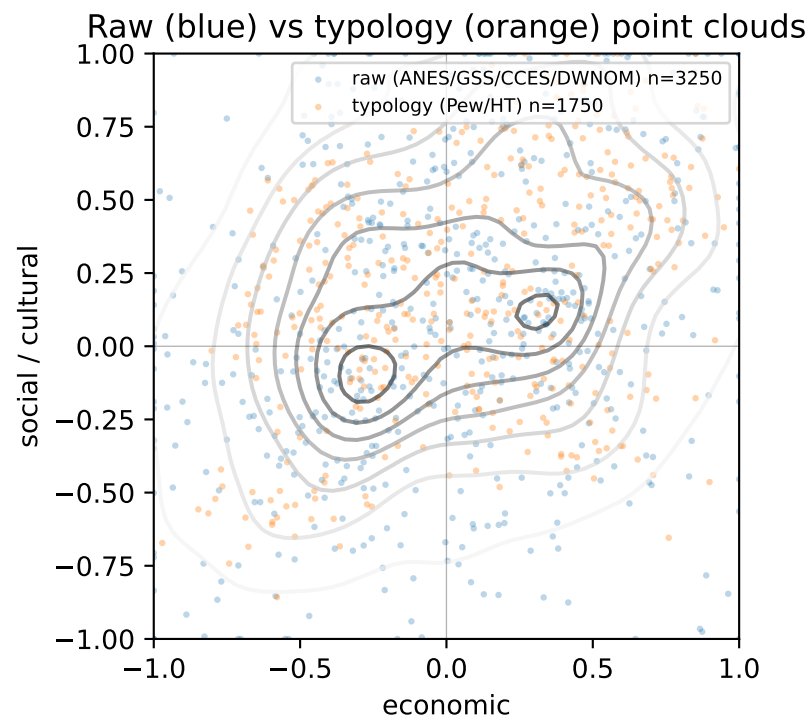
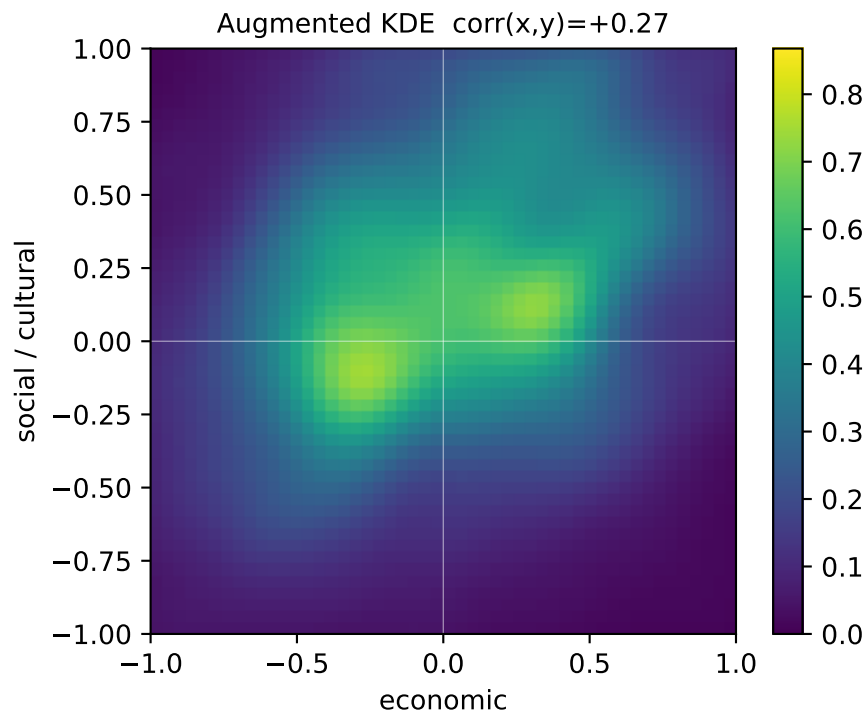
|                 |                        |        |
|-----------------|------------------------|--------|
| ANES_1980_synth | within-row weight=0.55 | n=1650 |
| GSS_1980_synth  | within-row weight=0.35 | n=1050 |
| DWNOM_1980      | within-row weight=0.10 | n=300  |

--- Diagnostics ---

combined  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.2622$   
raw-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.0988$   
typ-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.5814$   
combined  $\text{var}(x) = 0.244$   
combined  $\text{var}(y) = 0.215$   
combined  $\text{mean}|x| = 0.419$



**Decade 1990 -- 2 typology + 3 raw source(s), 1750 typ pts + 3250 raw pts = 5000 combined (raw weight = 65%)**



DECADE 1990 composition (raw weight = 65%):

--- Typology sources ---

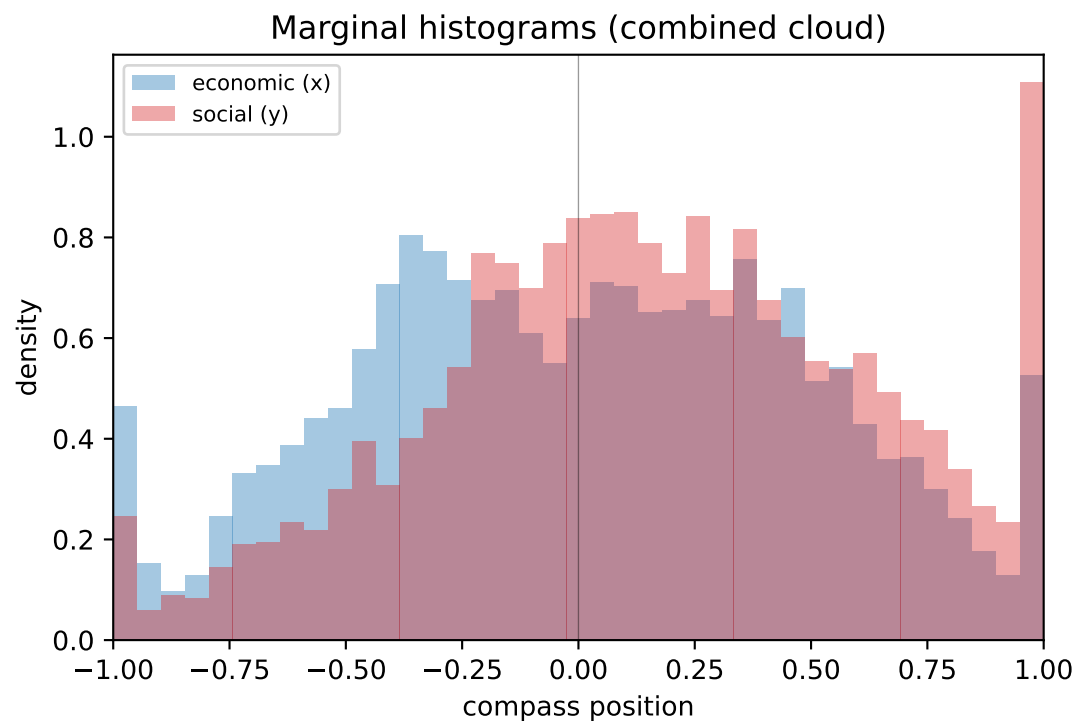
Pew\_1994 (SD=0.15, downsampled to 1750 total typ pts)  
Pew\_1999 (SD=0.15, downsampled to 1750 total typ pts)

--- Raw-style sources ---

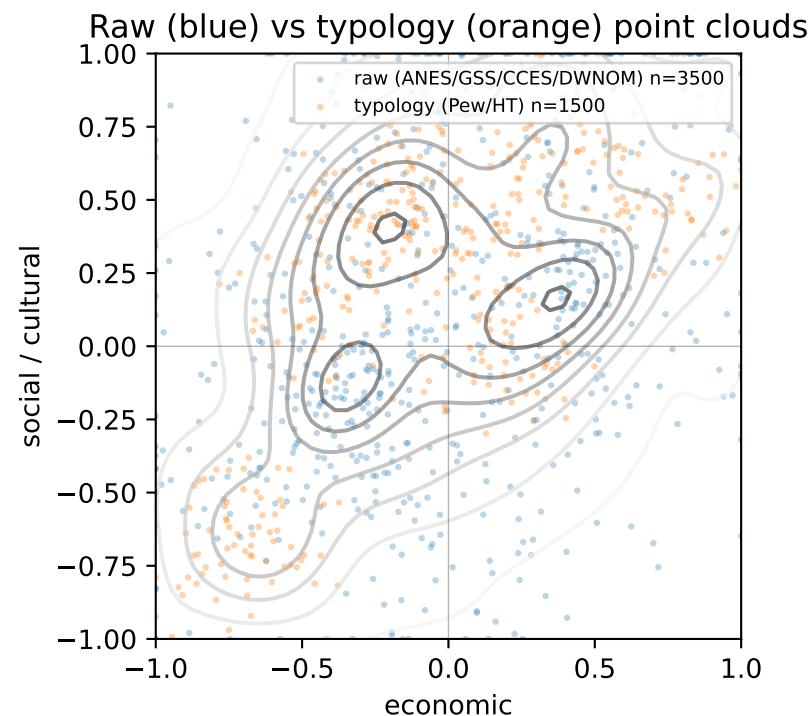
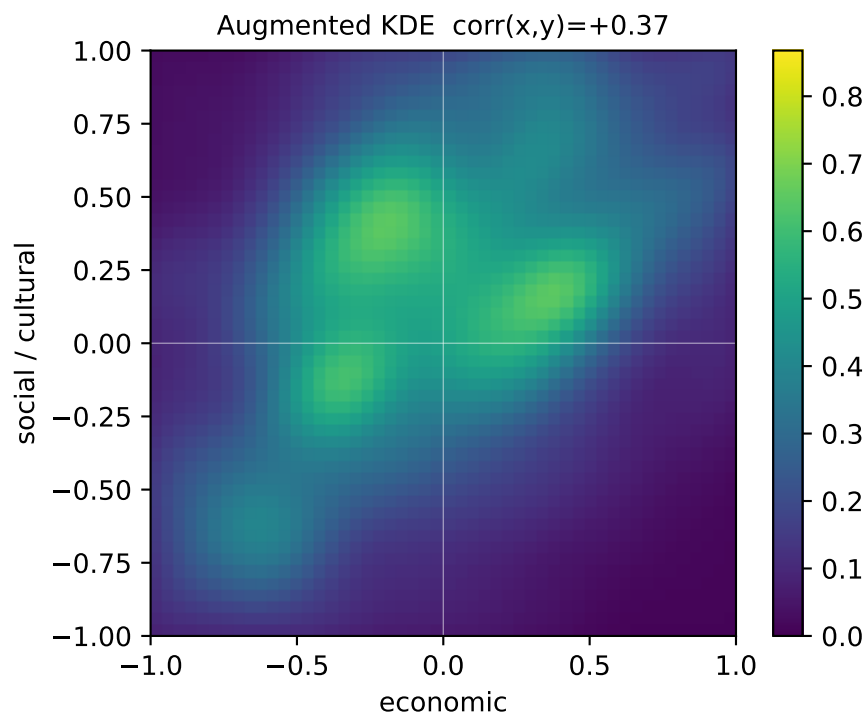
ANES\_1990\_synth within-row weight=0.50 n=1625  
GSS\_1990\_synth within-row weight=0.40 n=1300  
DWNOM\_1990 within-row weight=0.10 n=325

--- Diagnostics ---

combined  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.2734$   
raw-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.2234$   
typ-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.4003$   
combined  $\text{var}(x) = 0.234$   
combined  $\text{var}(y) = 0.218$   
combined  $\text{mean}|x| = 0.405$



**Decade 2000 -- 1 typology + 3 raw source(s), 1500 typ pts + 3500 raw pts = 5000 combined (raw weight = 70%)**

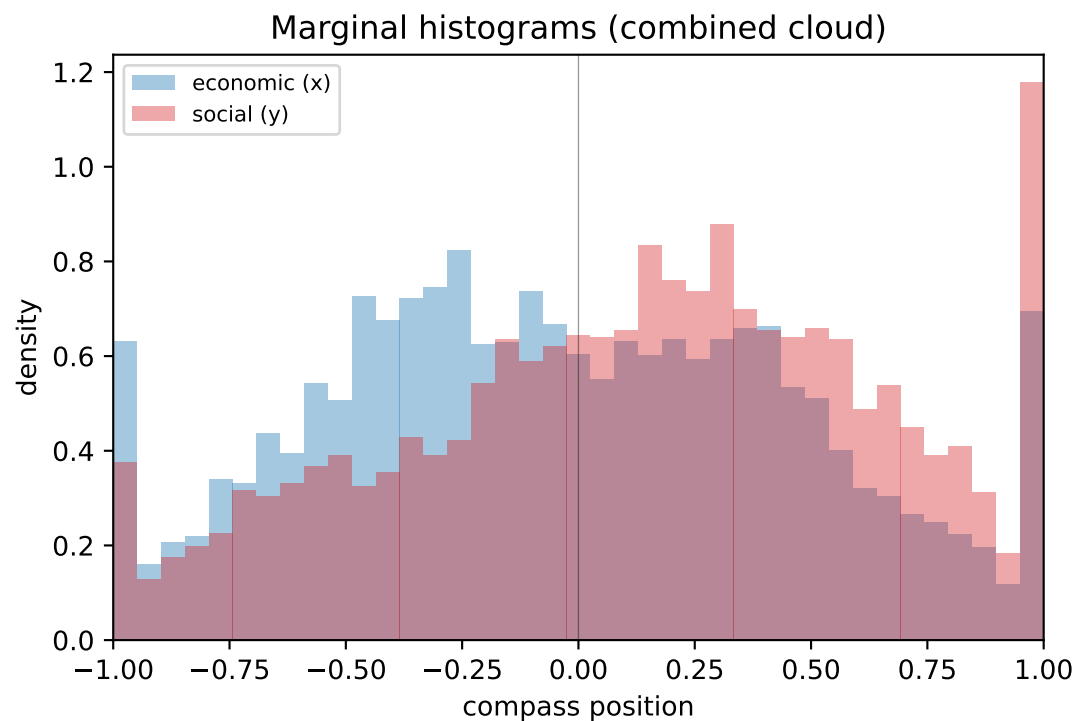


DECADE 2000 composition (raw weight = 70%):

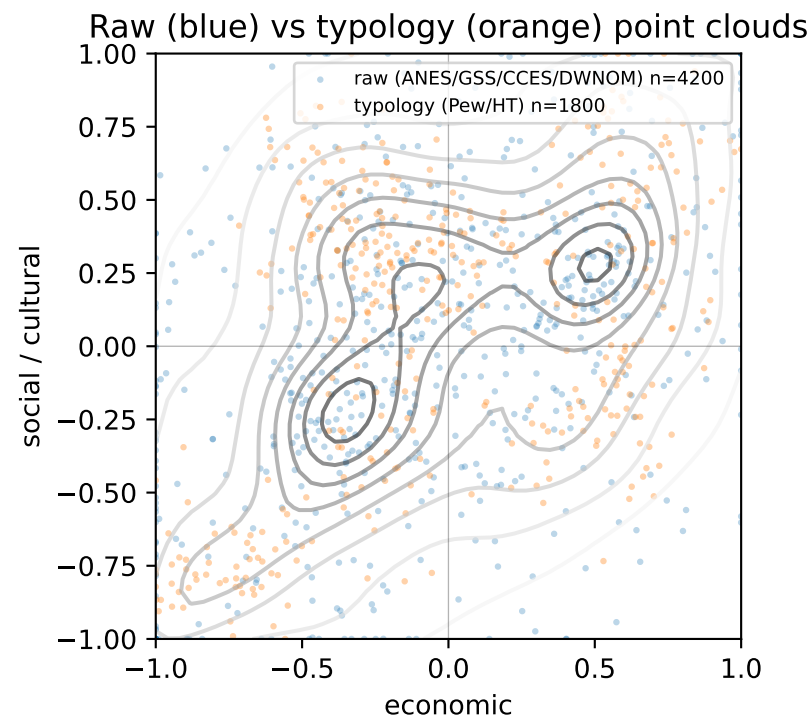
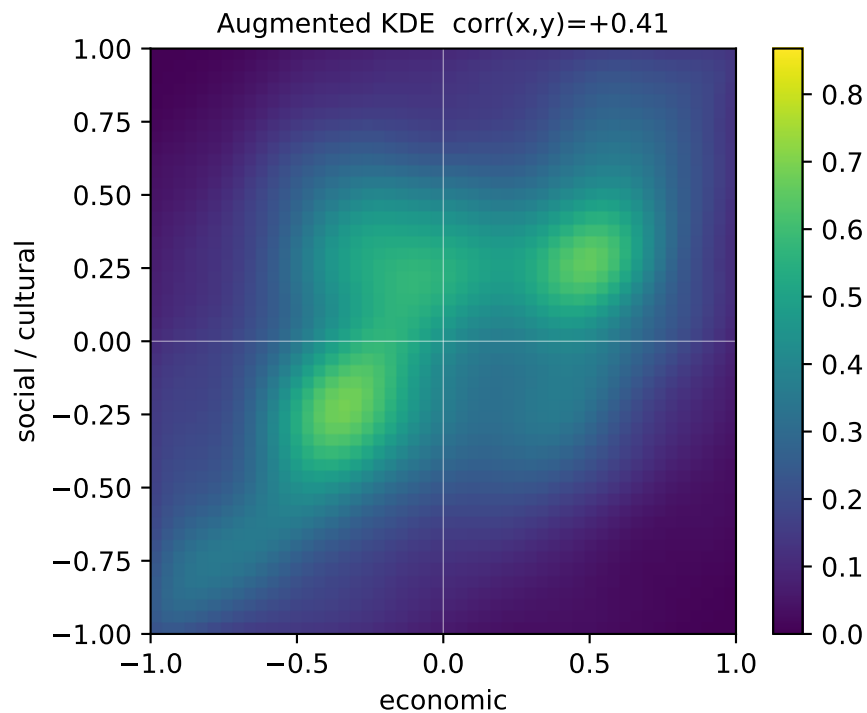
--- Typology sources ---  
Pew\_2005 (SD=0.15, downsampled to 1500 total typ pts)

--- Raw-style sources ---  
ANES\_2000\_synth within-row weight=0.50 n=1750  
GSS\_2000\_synth within-row weight=0.40 n=1400  
DWNOM\_2000 within-row weight=0.10 n=350

--- Diagnostics ---  
combined  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.3722$   
raw-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.2894$   
typ-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.6191$   
combined  $\text{var}(x) = 0.254$   
combined  $\text{var}(y) = 0.261$   
combined  $\text{mean}|x| = 0.421$



**Decade 2010 -- 2 typology + 4 raw source(s), 1800 typ pts + 4200 raw pts = 6000 combined (raw weight = 70%)**



DECADE 2010 composition (raw weight = 70%):

--- Typology sources ---

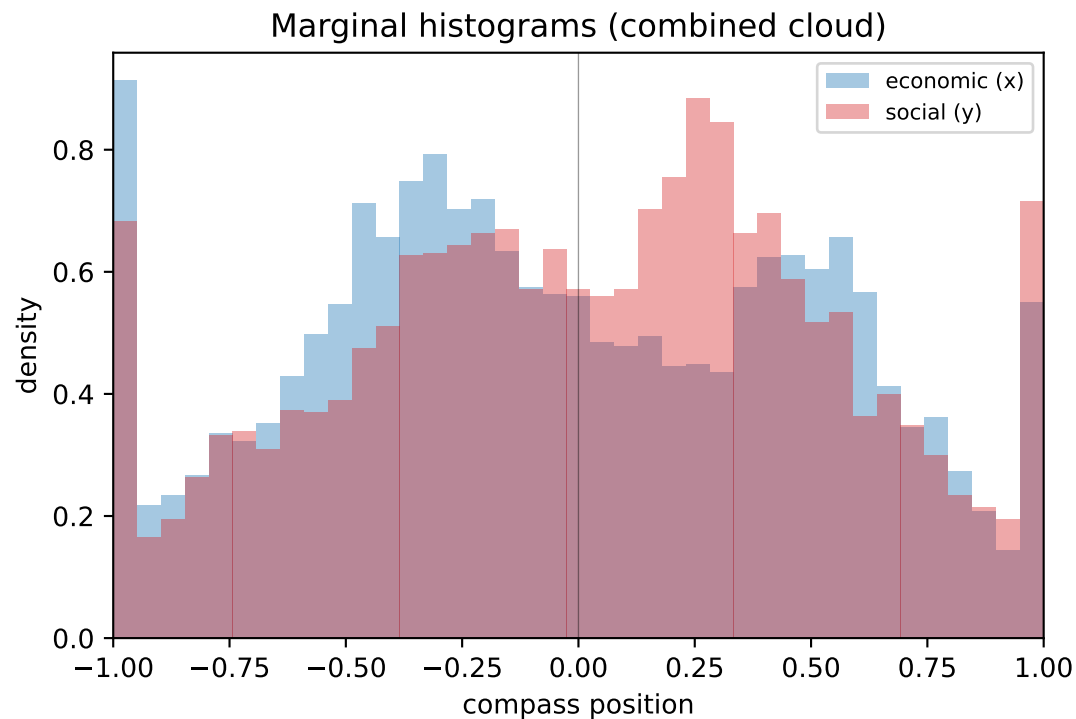
Pew\_2011 (SD=0.15, downsampled to 1800 total typ pts)  
Pew\_2014 (SD=0.15, downsampled to 1800 total typ pts)

--- Raw-style sources ---

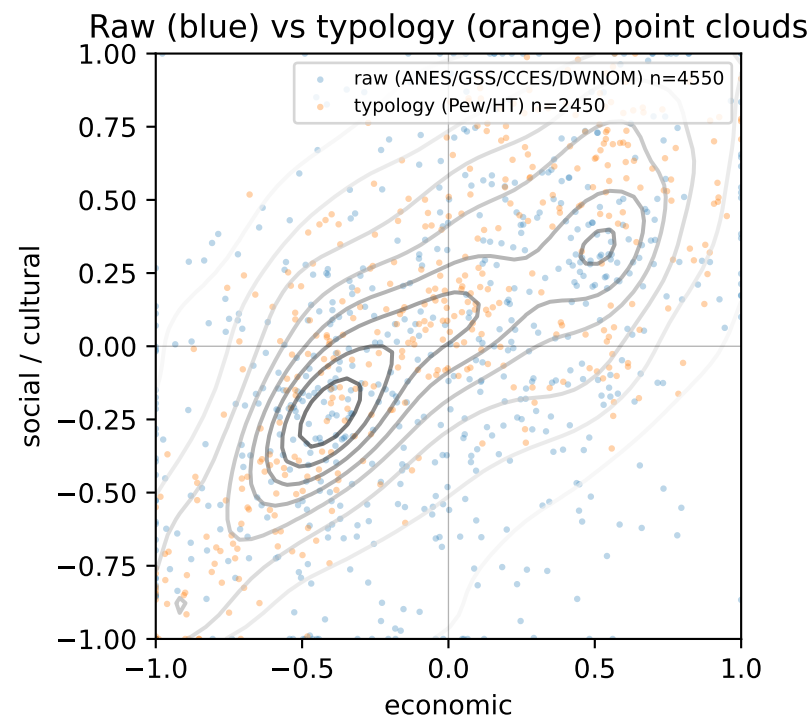
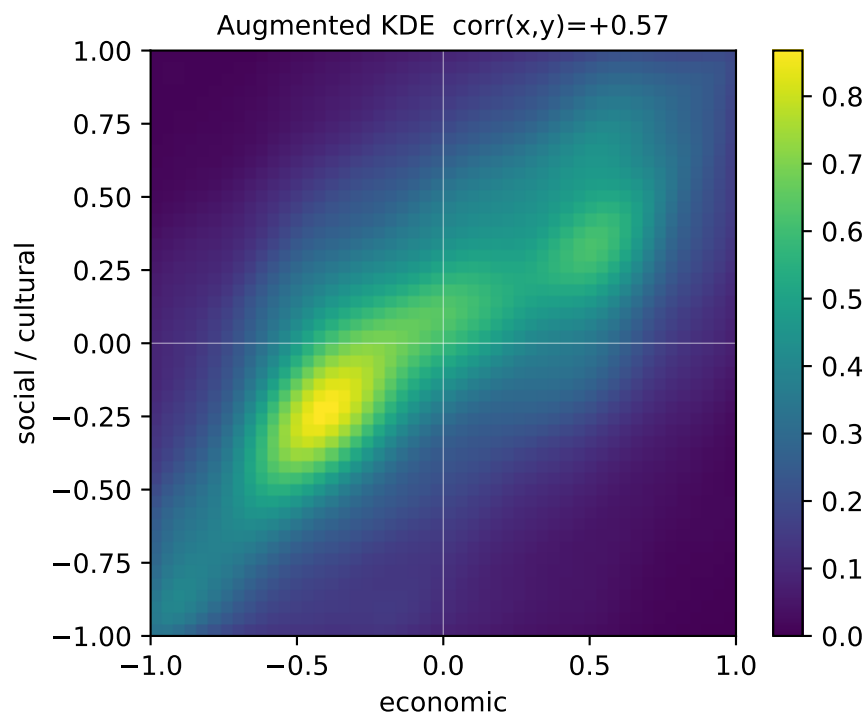
|                 |                        |        |
|-----------------|------------------------|--------|
| ANES_2010_synth | within-row weight=0.35 | n=1470 |
| GSS_2010_synth  | within-row weight=0.25 | n=1050 |
| CCES_2010_synth | within-row weight=0.30 | n=1260 |
| DWNOM_2010      | within-row weight=0.10 | n=420  |

--- Diagnostics ---

combined  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.4147$   
raw-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.3892$   
typ-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.4749$   
combined  $\text{var}(x) = 0.284$   
combined  $\text{var}(y) = 0.262$   
combined  $\text{mean}|x| = 0.454$



**Decade 2020 -- 3 typology + 4 raw source(s), 2450 typ pts + 4550 raw pts = 7000 combined (raw weight = 65%)**

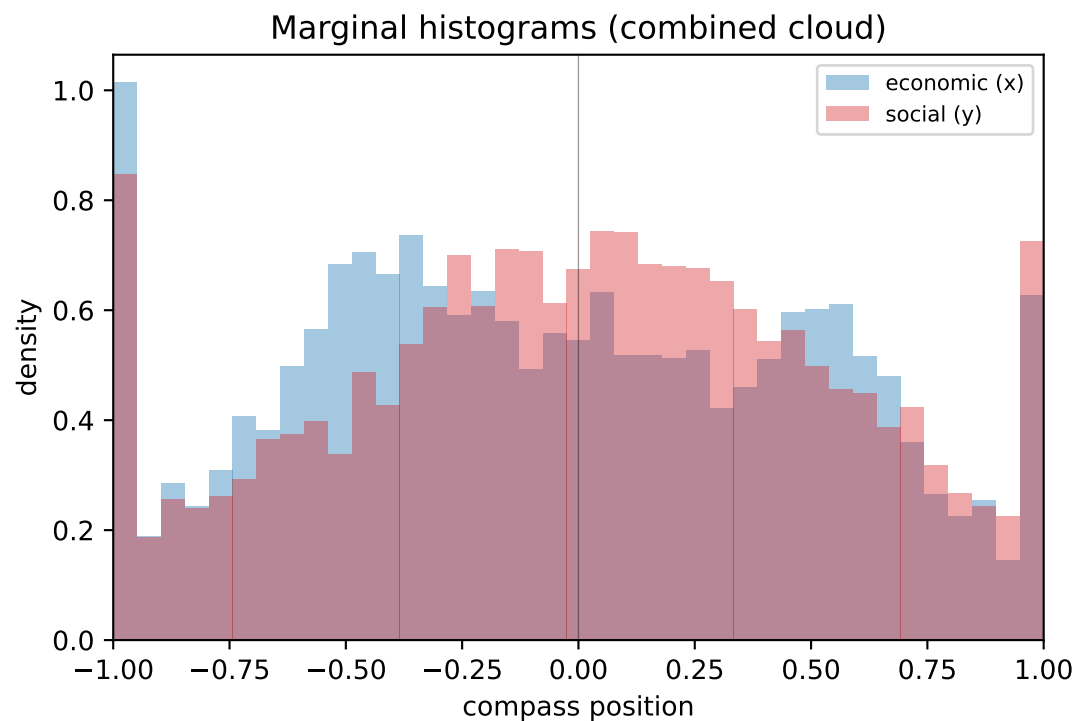


DECADE 2020 composition (raw weight = 65%):

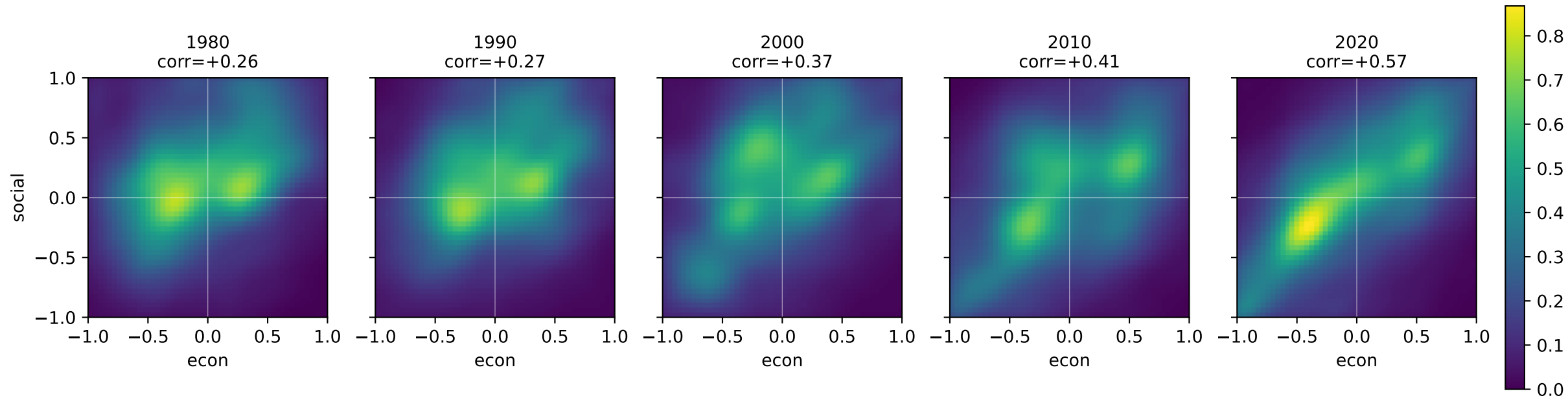
--- Typology sources ---  
Pew\_2017 (SD=0.15, downsampled to 2450 total typ pts)  
Pew\_2021 (SD=0.15, downsampled to 2450 total typ pts)  
HiddenTribes\_2018 (SD=0.15, downsampled to 2450 total typ pts)

--- Raw-style sources ---  
ANES\_2020\_synth within-row weight=0.30 n=1365  
GSS\_2020\_synth within-row weight=0.25 n=1137  
CCES\_2020\_synth within-row weight=0.35 n=1592  
DWNOM\_2020 within-row weight=0.10 n=456

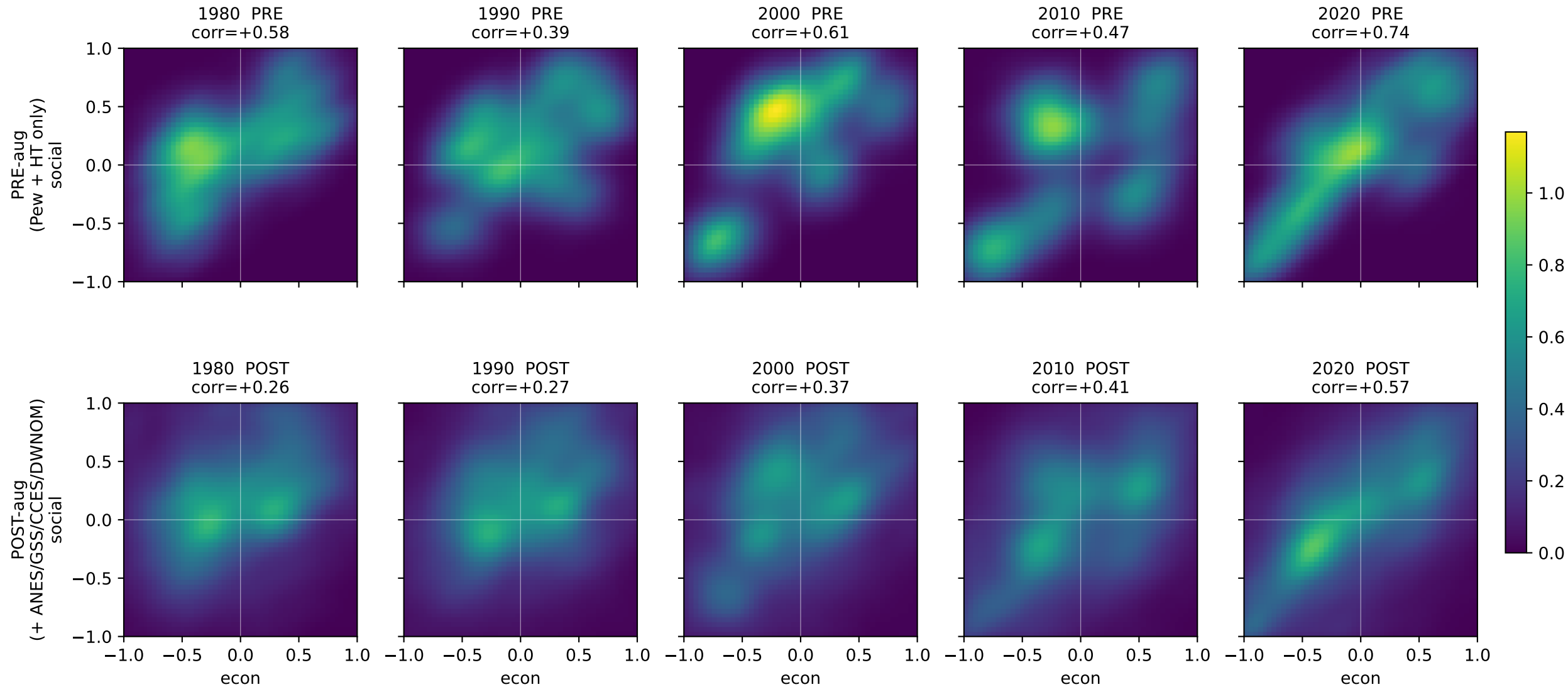
--- Diagnostics ---  
combined  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.5678$   
raw-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.4746$   
typ-only  $\text{corr}(x,y) = +0.7662$   
combined  $\text{var}(x) = 0.293$   
combined  $\text{var}(y) = 0.273$   
combined  $\text{mean}|x| = 0.462$



Augmented KDE trajectory 1980 -> 2020 (shared colorbar)



Before vs After Augmentation -- per-decade KDE comparison  
(PRE was Pew-typology-heavy and inflated x-y correlation; POST dilutes with raw-data-anchored moment-matched clouds)





Cross-axis correlation: pre vs post augmentation  
(closer to literature-measured = better)

